



MY BANGALORE JOURNEY

A Journey That Began With A Job Search — And Turned Into A Journey Of Compassion

1. THE CALL TO BANGALORE

There was a time when my sister and brother-in-law were living in HSR Layout, Bangalore. They were well settled there. One day, my brother-in-law encouraged me to try finding a job in the software field in Bangalore and suggested that I stay with them while searching.

I was excited by the idea. I already liked Bangalore, and I felt that the city might offer me a new beginning. After completing my engineering, I had spent nearly one and a half years struggling to find a suitable opportunity in the HAL area, particularly in the field of embedded systems. So, I decided to take his advice and travel to Bangalore.

2. LEARNING, TRYING — AND FACING DISAPPOINTMENT

Once I reached Bangalore, I enrolled in two different courses: ETL Development and Full Stack Development. I devoted around eight to ten months to learning and improving my technical skills. After completing the courses, I began applying for jobs.

But things did not go as I had hoped. Unfortunately, I could not find a job in either field. It was disappointing, but I continued moving forward.

3. MY FIRST JOB — AND A NEW CHAPTER

Eventually, I joined Countrees Technologies Private Limited in Varthur. It was a startup company working on two products, Biller and BillWallet, under the supervision of Software Developer Mr. Sanjay Panigrahi.

I worked there regularly from 10 a.m. to 5 p.m. It was an important stage of my professional life. At the same time, something completely different was beginning to take shape in my life — something I had never planned.

4. THE DAY I MET ANURAG SAHAY VERMA

One holiday, while I was helping rescue a Labrador, I met Mr. Anurag Sahay Verma. During our casual conversation, he invited me to visit his place sometime.

I was excited by the invitation, so I planned to visit the following Sunday. Without

telling anyone, I went there.

What I saw at that place deeply inspired me.

5. A PLACE THAT CHANGED THE WAY I SAW ANIMALS

Inside WAGGCITY, a dog boarding centre that also served as a rescue and care space, I saw a cow, around fifteen to eighteen rescued Indian street dogs, several abandoned rescued dogs, and even a rescued pig. Outside the centre, around ten to fifteen street dogs were also being cared for.

I arrived around 4 p.m. and stayed until about 10 p.m. When I finally returned home, I felt strangely happy and fulfilled.

I began volunteering there on holidays and Sundays. Gradually, I joined their groups and met animal activists, rescuers, veterinarians and Reiki practitioners. Sometimes, I also helped rescuers during horse and donkey rescue operations. I became involved in cases related to goats being sacrificed at temples, followed adoption cases, and participated in street-dog feeding using my scooter.

Without realizing it, I was becoming part of a world that was completely different from my professional life.

6. THE ANIMALS OF HSR LAYOUT

At the same time, I was taking care of around twenty street dogs near HSR Layout. Sometimes, I also helped animals I encountered on my way to the office.

I had developed a strong interest in observing the lives of street animals, especially dogs and cows. I wanted to understand their behaviour, their struggles, their relationships and the way they survived in the middle of a busy city.

My life continued like this for several months — work on one side and animals on the other.

7. THE BBMP VAN — AND MY FIRST BIG QUESTION

Then, one day, I saw a BBMP van arrive in HSR Layout. I watched as innocent street dogs were caught forcefully using net-catching tools and taken into the van.

I immediately asked why they were being taken away.

I was told that they had been instructed to remove the dogs from the locality and that, after sterilization or spaying/neutering, the dogs would be returned to the same locality.

At that time, this sounded very strange to me. I had never heard about this process before. I simply wanted to know what would happen to the dogs I knew and cared for.

8. SEARCHING FOR MY FRIENDS

After about a week, I became increasingly restless because the dogs had not yet returned. I decided to visit the BBMP office myself.

When I asked about the dogs, I was told, in effect, to trust the process and that the dogs would be brought back the following week.

The next day, following directions from the staff, I searched another place where I was told the dogs might be kept. Eventually, I found a temporary-shelter-like area where many dogs were being housed.

At that moment, I realized that some good work was indeed being carried out by BBMP. But another question remained in my mind: if the process was happening, why had my friends from HSR Layout not come back?

I was allowed to check whether the dogs from my locality were there. I searched, but I could not find them.

I was told to wait a few more days and assured that they would return. So I waited.

9. THREE WEEKS LATER

After about three weeks, the dogs finally returned.

I felt genuinely happy to see them again.

That experience changed something inside me. I had started with a simple concern for a few street dogs, but the experience pushed me to understand the larger world of animal welfare — rescue, sterilization, treatment, rehabilitation and responsible care.

10. WHAT WAGGCITY TAUGHT ME

Gradually, through my association with WAGGCITY, the boarding-cum-rescue centre, I began learning many things.

I learned about the Animal Birth Control (ABC) process and gained practical exposure to the care and treatment of dogs suffering from illnesses such as Parvo and Canine Distemper (CD). I learned how seriously maggot-infested wounds can affect an animal, and I gained basic practical knowledge of IM and SC injections and a little understanding of IV fluids under appropriate supervision.

I also learned how to socialize dogs, how to care for them, how to select suitable food, and how important patience, observation and consistency are when dealing with rescued animals.

More importantly, I learned that helping an animal is not simply about giving food or treatment. It is about understanding fear, pain, trust and recovery.

11. THE BEGINNING OF SOMETHING BIGGER

What began in Bangalore as a simple attempt to find a software job gradually became something much deeper.

I had gone to Bangalore looking for professional stability. Instead, I discovered another direction in life — one that brought me closer to animals, rescuers, veterinarians, volunteers and countless stories of suffering and survival.

The city gave me professional experience, but the animals gave me a different kind of education — an education of compassion, responsibility and courage.

□□ MORAL OF THE JOURNEY □□

Sometimes, we travel to a place searching for one destination, but life quietly opens the door to another. A failed job search can become a lesson; a rescued animal can become a teacher; and a small act of kindness can become a lifelong mission.

MY JOURNEY STARTED FROM HERE...



MY JOURNEY IN WAGGCITY

A personal memoir of my time at WAGGCITY — The Boarding Cum Rescue Center

12. WHEN WAGGCITY BECAME PART OF MY LIFE

From **11th October 2018 to 30th May 2019**, I worked as the **Manager at WAGGCITY — The Boarding Cum Rescue Center**.

By then, WAGGCITY was no longer just a place I visited on holidays and Sundays. It had become a regular part of my life.

Every day brought different dogs, different situations and different responsibilities. Some dogs were friendly and playful, some were timid, some were sick, and some had behavioural problems.

I had to learn to understand them individually.

Looking back, I feel that this period taught me more through practical experience than I could have learned from any book.

13. THE NEWCOMER REGISTER

One of my responsibilities was maintaining the register for every new pet that came to WAGGCITY.

I used to record the dog's behaviour, response to commands, any ongoing sickness and medication, food pattern, socialization issues, temperament, breed and age.

I also recorded the owner's details and the boarding period.

I paid particular attention to whether a dog was **amiable, timid or aggressive**.

For me, these details were not just formal entries. They helped me understand what to expect from a dog and how I should deal with it.

A dog entering a new place may behave differently from the way it behaves at home. So I found it important to know its background before making any assumptions about it.

14. LEARNING FROM ANURAG SIR

One of the things I wanted to learn most was **how to socialize dogs with one another**.

I learned many techniques from **Anurag Sir, Mr. Anurag Sahay Verma**, the owner of WAGGCITY.



He had much more experience than I did, so I used to watch him carefully.

I noticed how he approached different dogs, when he allowed them to interact, when he intervened and how he responded to their behaviour.

Slowly, I started developing my own confidence.

I realized that there was no fixed formula. One dog might respond immediately, while another might need much more time.

That practical learning became one of the most useful parts of my time at WAGGCITY.

15. KEEPING THE ENVIRONMENT PLAYFUL

I always wanted the dogs to have a playful atmosphere.

They were staying there temporarily, and I did not want the place to feel like somewhere they were simply waiting to leave.

I liked seeing them interact, run around and play.

When a dog that had initially been nervous gradually became comfortable enough to play, I felt genuinely happy.

Those small moments made the daily work enjoyable.

16. TAKING CARE OF SICK DOGS

The sick dogs required a different kind of attention.

Apart from their medicines and regular needs, I tried to keep them comfortable and in a good mood.

I would spend time with them and observe how they were behaving.

Sometimes I could tell from their appetite or behaviour that something was different.

My personal aim was always to make them feel **as comfortable as possible, even more comfortable than they might have been at home.**

I wanted WAGGCITY to feel like a safe place for them while they recovered.

17. WHEN DOGS FOUGHT



Not every day was peaceful.

Sometimes dogs became aggressive or started fighting.

When that happened, I had to separate them quickly.

If one dog was particularly aggressive, I would keep it separately inside the **6 × 6 feet cage** until things became calmer.

At such times, I used commands such as:

“No.”

“Behave Yourself.”

“Sit.”

These commands became part of my everyday communication with the dogs.

I learned that handling dogs sometimes required affection and sometimes required firmness.

The important thing was to remain calm and consistent.

18. THE COMMANDS I USED

The basic commands I commonly used were:

“Sit.” “Come.” “Behave Yourself.” “Don't Fight.”

“No.” “Eat.” “Drink.” “Go.”

They were simple commands, but I gradually understood how much depended on the timing and manner in which they were given.

19. SUPERVISING THE DAILY WORK

As Manager, I was also responsible for supervising the people allotted for different daily duties.

This included:

- Cooking
- Cleaning
- Feeding
- Maintaining the daily routine of the centre

Animal care involves a lot of routine work that people outside may never notice.

Food has to be prepared on time. The premises have to remain clean. Dogs have to be fed properly. Their behaviour has to be watched. Everything has to work together.



This responsibility gave me a different understanding of what it meant to manage an animal-care centre.

20. FEEDING STREET DOGS

My connection with street dogs continued during this period.

I used to **feed street dogs in the nearby areas every day**.

I had already been taking care of street dogs around HSR Layout before becoming part of WAGGCITY.

By then, I had started recognizing individual dogs by their appearance and behaviour.

Feeding them became part of my routine, and I enjoyed seeing the familiar faces waiting for me.

21. RESCUE OPERATIONS AND SPOT-ON TREATMENT

Whenever I got an opportunity, I voluntarily participated in **rescue operations and Spot-On treatment services**.

I wanted to experience the work outside the routine of the boarding centre as well.

Rescue situations were unpredictable. Every case was different.

Sometimes an animal was frightened. Sometimes the situation required quick action. Sometimes we had to wait patiently before the animal could be handled.

These experiences gave me practical exposure to a completely different side of animal welfare.

WAGGCITY gave me more opportunities to continue the work I had already started.

22. HELPING AT AN OLD-AGE HOME

Sometimes my work also took me beyond animals.

There were occasions when **Anurag Sir personally contributed food items for an old-age home**, and I helped deliver them.

I remember these occasions because they showed me that the work around WAGGCITY was not limited to the dogs inside the centre.

23. WHAT I LEARNED FROM ANURAG SIR

Anurag Sir had a major influence on my journey.

He was more experienced than me, especially when it came to understanding and handling dogs.

I learned a lot from him by simply being around him and observing his methods.

However, there was one important area where my personal thinking was different:

I could not comfortably accept the idea of killing one animal to feed another.

That difference made me think seriously about my own beliefs.

24. MY THINKING ABOUT NATURE

I started looking at the question from a slightly different angle.

In a jungle, a tiger may kill another animal for food. That is part of the natural system.

I don't believe we can apply human rules to everything happening in a forest.

But I see a difference when an animal comes **under our custody or protection**.

If an innocent animal is now in my care, I believe I should use my ability to think and find a way to protect it. At the same time, I don't want to harm the predator unnecessarily either.

For me, that is where human choice becomes important.

25. THE SNAKE AND THE FROG

A snake naturally eats a frog.

But if a snake is attacking a frog directly in front of me, and I can safely separate them without hurting either animal, why should I simply stand there and say:

"This is the jungle rule"?

I would rather separate them safely.

The snake can go its way. The frog can go its way.

To me, that is one difference between **nature operating by instinct and human beings exercising choice**.

26. THE QUESTION OF FOOD



This way of thinking created an internal conflict for me.

At WAGGCITY, dogs were sometimes fed chicken or mutton. I understood the practical reason behind it.

But personally, I began to feel uncomfortable with the idea of feeding one animal by using another animal's life.

The more I became involved in rescue work, the more strongly I felt this conflict.

For me, this was not about criticizing somebody else. It was about asking myself:

“What do I personally believe?”

That question became connected with my own spiritual growth.

27. WAGGCITY AND MY OWN GROWTH

WAGGCITY changed me in practical ways.

I became more confident in handling dogs. I learned how to read their behaviour. I learned how to manage difficult situations. I learned how much planning and routine are required to run an animal-care centre.

I learned from Anurag Sir. I met different kinds of people involved in animal welfare. And I continued to discover more about the lives of animals.

My Bangalore journey had already taken me away from the career path I had originally imagined.

WAGGCITY took that journey one step further.

28. THE END OF MY WAGGCITY PERIOD

My work as Manager at WAGGCITY ended on **30th May 2019**.

But the experience did not end with the job.

I carried many memories with me — the dogs I handled, the sick dogs I looked after, the street dogs I fed, the rescue operations and the lessons I learned from Anurag Sir.

Most importantly, I carried my own questions with me.

What does it really mean to protect an animal?

Where does nature end and human responsibility begin?

And when we have the ability to choose a less harmful option, should we not choose it?



I did not have all the answers at that time.

But I knew that these questions had become a part of me.

MY BELIEF

“In the jungle, nature follows its own rules. But when a life comes under my protection, I believe I have a responsibility to use my intelligence and choices carefully — without unnecessarily harming another life.”

WAGGCITY was where this thought became much clearer to me.